

ORDER In the County Court at Sheffield
District Judge LH Hivesbury

Case number:
K7QZ4318

Parties	George Bertram Dobbs	Claimant
	Adrian Reeves	Defendant

Warning: you must comply with the terms imposed upon you by this order otherwise your case is liable to be struck out or some other sanction imposed. If you cannot comply you are expected to make formal application to the court before any deadline imposed upon you expires.

On 06 January 2026

District Judge L H Hivesbury sitting at the County Court at Sheffield, considered the papers in the case and

ordered that:

- 1) The Claim is allocated to the small-claims track and is assigned to District Judge L H Hivesbury.
- 2) At all stages the parties must consider settling this litigation by any means of Alternative Dispute Resolution (including Mediation); any party not engaging in any such means proposed by another must serve a witness statement giving reasons within 21 days of that proposal; such witness statement must not be shown to the judge hearing the claim until questions of costs arise.
- 3) Disclosure of documents will be dealt with as follows:
 - a) by 4pm on 27 January 2026 the parties must give to each other standard disclosure of documents by list and category.
 - b) by 4pm on 10 February 2026 any request must be made to inspect the original of, or to provide a copy of, a disclosable document.
 - c) any such request unless objected to must be complied with within 14 days of the request.
 - d) by 4pm on 17 February 2026 each party must serve and file with the Court a list of issues relevant to the search for and disclosure of electronically stored documents, or must confirm there are no such issues, following Practice Direction 31B.
- 4) Evidence of fact will be dealt with as follows:
 - a) by 4pm on 03 March 2026 all parties must serve on each other copies of the signed statements of themselves and of all witnesses on whom they intend to rely and all notices relating to evidence.

- b) Oral evidence will not be permitted at the final hearing from a witness whose statement has not been served in accordance with this order or has been served late, except with permission from the Court.
- c) Evidence of fact is limited to 3 witnesses on behalf of each party.
- d) Witness statements must not exceed 12 pages of A4 in length.
- 5) No party has permission to adduce expert evidence. Any party wishing to rely on expert evidence must apply to the Court.
- 6) Schedules of Loss must be updated as follows:
 - a) by 4pm on 17 March 2026 the Claimant must send an up to date schedule of loss to each other party.
 - b) by 4pm on 24 March 2026 a Defendant, in the event of challenge, must send an up to date counter-schedule of loss to the Claimant.
- 7) The final hearing will be listed as follows.
 - a) The hearing window is between 13 April 2026 and 24 April 2026 inclusive.
 - b) The estimated length of the final hearing is 2 hours.
 - c) By 4pm on 24 February 2026 the parties must file with the court their availability for the final hearing, preferably agreed and with a nominated single point of contact. They will be notified of the time and place of the final hearing.
 - d) By 4pm on 31 March 2026 pre-hearing check lists must be sent to the court.
- 8) Pre-hearing directions are as follows:
 - a) There will be a pre-hearing review 4 weeks before the hearing window starts with a time estimate of 30 minutes.
 - b) The pre-hearing review may be conducted by telephone if the parties so agree, unless the court orders otherwise. The Claimant must make the relevant arrangements in accordance with Practice Direction 23A Civil Procedure Rules.
 - c) At least 3 clear days before the pre-hearing review the Claimant must file and send to the other party or parties preferably agreed and by email:
 - i) draft directions
 - ii) a chronology
 - iii) a case summary.
- 9) The final-hearing directions are as follows:
 - a) Not more than 7 nor less than 3 clear days before the final hearing, the Claimant must file at court and serve an indexed and paginated bundle of

documents, which complies with the requirements of Rule 39.5 Civil Procedure Rules and Practice Direction 32 paragraph 27. The parties must endeavour to agree the contents of the bundle before it is filed. The bundle will include:

- i) a chronology.
 - ii) a hearing timetable.
- b) the parties must file with the court and exchange skeleton arguments at least 3 days before the final hearing by email.
- 10) Because this Order has been made without a hearing, the parties have the right to apply to have the order set aside, varied or stayed. A party making such an application must send or deliver the application to the court (together with any appropriate fee) to arrive within 7 days of service of this Order.